

BONG TOUR

Written by Sean Halls

LOGLINE

When two broke stoner writers in L.A. score a “holy” Bangladeshi bong and let a washed-up C-lister smoke them into a Comedy Store meeting, their half-Hollywood/half-Dhollywood *Lord of the Rings*-riffing fantasy suddenly gets optioned by a deranged A-lister, launching a blackout showbiz gauntlet of casting disasters, ego cults, and a very real warning: don’t cross the Lollipop Guild.

GENRE

Comedy | Satire | Adventure

tone & comparables

Bong Tour blends the hallucinatory paranoia of *Fear & Loathing in Las Vegas* with the industry self-immolation of *The Player*, filtering stoner mythology through a sharply observant, often uncomfortable Hollywood satire. Its humor is absurd but deliberate, less about intoxication than about what intoxication reveals.

Tonally, the film lives in the space between *The Big Lebowski*’s philosophical drift and *Inherent Vice*’s moral hangover: a lucid nightmare where creative ambition, cultural identity, and institutional hypocrisy collide. The result is a kinetic yet reflective comedy that skewers entertainment-industry power structures while maintaining a sincere, if bruised, belief in the value of authentic storytelling.

SYNOPSIS

ACT ONE: THE BONG, THE MYTH, THE LEGEND

The film opens on the banks of the Ganges in West Bengal, where a severely injured little person, Montu, sets a single object adrift in a basket, an act that feels less sacred than desperate. The object itself, initially suggesting the baby Moses floating down the Nile, is revealed to be a bong that will quietly accumulate meaning,

ownership, and consequence as it passes through other people's hands within the film.

We cut to present-day Los Angeles. On Sunset Boulevard, aspiring screenwriters Vishal, an anxious, idealistic Indian-American and Drew, his reckless, conspiracy-obsessed creative partner are hotboxing their van on the way to a pitch. They are broke, unfocused, and clinging to the belief that their half-Hollywood, half-South Asian fantasy epic, *Bhang Tour*, is their way out of obscurity.

Almost no one ever gets the name right.

Bhang, a traditional cannabis drink with cultural and religious roots, is constantly misheard, misremembered, or casually rewritten as *Bong*. Drew finds this funny. Vishal does not. From the beginning, the project's identity is being flattened into something easier to sell, easier to market, and easier for other people to claim.

They are also far too high to function.

In a haze of paranoia and self-justification, they accidentally hit a man crossing the street who turns out to be Jack, a friend and struggling actor, already battered and wearing a motion-capture suit from an off-the-books gig. Faced with the reality of what they've done, Vishal wants to help. Drew reframes. Jack becomes "fine," then a "narrative obstacle," then an inconvenience. Instead of taking him to the hospital, they strip him of the motion-capture suit, something they irrationally believe is essential to selling their movie and leave him behind. It's the first moment where creative ambition overrides basic decency, even as they insist they're still the good guys.

The film flashes back to what led our unlikely heroes to hit Jack, and we are introduced to Willie, Vishal's sharp, pragmatic best friend and an assistant on the fringes of the industry, who tries to ground them. The situation escalates when a washed-up C-list actor, now reduced to delivering weed, forces his way inside, smokes their stash, and latches onto their script. He immediately "corrects" the title to *Bong Tour*, dismissing Vishal's explanation as semantics. Sensing opportunity, he positions himself as a gatekeeper with real industry access and insists on bringing them, and the bong, to The Comedy Store that night.

Willie clocks their condition immediately, questions the pitch, and warns them not to let anyone else reframe the project for them. Drew dismisses her concerns. Vishal listens, but doesn't act. Willie stays behind, already sensing that whatever happens next will move too fast to stop.

What follows is an unhinged initiation into Hollywood's inner machinery. At the Comedy Store, Vishal and Drew are pulled into a drug-fueled backroom pitch to an unstable A-list actor, where storytelling gives way to a shared psychedelic experience. By the end of the night, the movie is suddenly "real," the title has

already been misbranded, and everyone in the room claims to understand the story better than the people who wrote it.

Act One ends in celebration and disorientation: a champagne-soaked party, viral photos, and the intoxicating sense that they've made it, without yet realizing that *Bhang Tour* may already be gone, replaced by a version of itself that the industry finds easier to swallow.

ACT TWO: HOLLYWOOD

Act Two begins the morning after the Comedy Store pitch, as Vishal and Drew wake up to discover their lives have changed, publicly, suddenly, and without their consent. TMZ headlines announce a mystery project backed by an A-Lister. Casting notices are already circulating. Their script, still titled *Bhang Tour* in Vishal's mind, is now being referred to everywhere as *Bong Tour*.

They did not sign anything.
They were not consulted.
But the machine has started.

Back at the Comedy Store, Vishal and Drew stumble into an active casting call for their own movie. The washed-up C-Lister, convinced this is his redemption arc, delivers an excruciating, racially mangled audition for a lead role clearly not meant for him. He believes he has the part "in the bag." He does not. The humiliation is public, irreversible, and revealing.

What becomes clear is that the A-Lister is no longer "developing" their film, he is directing it. With manic confidence and faux-spiritual certainty, he reframes *Bhang Tour* into a sprawling, self-congratulatory epic that fetishizes little people, replaces cultural specificity with spectacle, and congratulates itself for being progressive while doing real harm. It also looks and feels eerily like *Lord of the Rings*. Casting decisions are made arbitrarily. Jockeys are substituted for little people. A German Shepherd is given a motion-capture role. Any objections are waved off as naïveté.

The C-Lister, realizing he's been used and discarded, spirals. His resentment turns dangerous.

Meanwhile, Willie, now peripherally involved through production and press, watches the production unfold from the outside. She sees what Vishal and Drew are too stunned to fully process: the movie is no longer theirs. Their names still open doors, but their voices no longer matter. When Vishal tries to push back, questioning casting, tone, and cultural authenticity, the A-Lister reframes resistance as betrayal, reminding them how replaceable writers are once production is underway.

Behind the scenes, “Upper Management” emerges as a faceless but omnipresent force, part financiers, part fixers, part myth, quietly steering the chaos toward profit. The bong, now passed freely between executives, performers, and hangers-on, becomes a ritual object of belonging. Everyone claims it gave them their best ideas. Everyone believes it belongs to them.

As filming escalates into something grotesque and out of control, Vishal, Drew and Willie are forced to confront an unsettling truth: success has arrived, but agency has not. Their movie is being made, but its soul is slipping away, rewritten scene by scene by people who insist they’re honoring it.

Act Two ends with a clear fracture. The C-Lister vanishes. The A-Lister descends further into delusion. The production barrels forward regardless. And Vishal realizes the only thing anyone still needs from them is an ending, one they’re being sent halfway around the world to find.

ACT THREE: DHOLLYWOOD

Act Three begins as Vishal and Drew are sent to West Bengal under the banner of “authenticity.” The production claims it needs the soul of the story to finish the film, but the reality is more strategic: the movie is spiraling out of control in Los Angeles, and the writers are easier to manage at a distance. Vishal’s cultural background, once treated as an obstacle, is suddenly essential, useful raw material for an ending he will not be allowed to control.

West Bengal offers no spiritual clarity. It is overwhelming, crowded, bureaucratic, and destabilizing. Vishal is forced into direct contact with a culture he has referenced intellectually but lived apart from. Drew, cut off from Hollywood validation and the feedback loop that sustains him, begins to unravel. Without access, applause, or the bong, his bravado curdles into paranoia.

As they retrace the origin of the bong through West Bengal, the film confirms what has been hinted at all along: the bong is real, and it works. It doesn’t merely intensify intoxication, it produces visions, alters probability, and opens access to experiences that feel prophetic and uncontrollable. People who use it don’t just get high; they see things, make impossible leaps, and behave with an amplified sense of destiny. The effects are consistent, repeatable, and dangerous.

The truth about Montu finally comes into focus. His catastrophic injury occurred during an encounter with the bong, not as part of a myth or ritual, but through reckless escalation. What began as a “fun movie” turned into obsession, risk-taking, and production-grade harm. Montu released the bong into the river out of fear, recognizing that it was doing something to people and that keeping it meant inviting further damage.

Intercut with this investigation is the most unsettling development of all: after weeks out of sight... the washed-up C-Lister has come into possession of the bong, and his fortunes reverse almost immediately. His knockoff version of the film, also titled *Bhang Tour*, begins to rise at an impossible speed...in West Bengal. Meetings land. Money appears. His ideas suddenly work. The industry, which once mocked him, now treats him as a visionary. The bong becomes his secret weapon, and he believes it has chosen him.

As the C-Lister's film ascends, the A-Lister's production of *Bong Tour* collapses into excess and incoherence. The A-Lister grows increasingly messianic, convinced the bong is guiding the movie. Upper Management attempts to harness its power for damage control, but every effort to control it only accelerates the chaos. The bong creates momentum, not stability; it rewards audacity and amplifies delusion.

In West Bengal, the consequences turn physical. The human cost of the bong's influence becomes undeniable, culminating in a violent, uncontrolled convergence at the Ganges. What began as a metaphorical journey becomes an actual chase for authorship, agency, and survival. Vishal and Drew finally stop reacting and start documenting, reclaiming the story not by pitching it, but by capturing what is actually happening.

The climax unfolds on the riverbank. The A-Lister, still convinced he controls the narrative, is physically and symbolically locked out of the ending. Willie steps in, not as a sidekick, but as the only person who has seen clearly from the beginning, blocking him from escaping with the story. Vishal and Drew film the truth as it happens, wresting control away in real time.

The bong's journey ends where it began. It is returned to the river, not ceremonially, but decisively. This is not myth fulfillment; it is containment. The object that has driven ambition, destruction, and impossible success is removed from circulation because leaving it in the world means inviting more damage.

WHY THIS STORY?

➤ A SATIRE WITH CONSEQUENCES.

Bong Tour skewers Hollywood's obsession with hype, access, and self-mythologizing: not from the outside, but from deep inside the machine. It exposes how creative exploitation is often disguised as opportunity, how "good intentions" excuse bad systems, and how quickly authorship is lost once power enters the room. The comedy is broad, but the critique is precise.

➤ A WILD RIDE, WITH A POINT.

This is not a traditional stoner comedy. *Bong Tour* is a surreal, globe-spanning odyssey that blends heightened adventure with uncomfortably recognizable industry behavior. The film embraces chaos, but never without consequence; every

laugh is tethered to a choice, and every escalation reveals something true about ambition, complicity, and survival.

➤ **BUILT FOR CULT STATUS**

Like *The Big Lebowski*, *Fear and Loathing in Las Vegas*, and *Tropic Thunder*, *Bong Tour* balances outrageous set pieces with a core of unsettling honesty. It's quotable, rewatchable, and deliberately excessive: designed to reward both casual viewers and those who recognize the industry it's skewering.

MARKETABILITY & TARGET AUDIENCE

- Audiences drawn to self-aware filmmaking, absurdist comedy, and Hollywood satire that punches inward rather than downward.
 - Millennials and Gen Z creatives who grew up on epic fantasy and now navigate freelance culture, media precarity, and institutional hypocrisy.
 - The indie and arthouse space, where irreverent, risk-taking comedies with strong authorial voices thrive.
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FINAL THOUGHTS

Bong Tour isn't just a movie about drugs or Hollywood: it's about what happens when creative ambition collides with systems that reward excess, myth, and denial. It's funny, destabilizing, and unexpectedly emotional...it asks whether the dream is worth the distortion required to survive it. In the end, *Bong Tour* suggests that Hollywood isn't a destination or a nightmare: it's a loop. And once you're in it, the hardest thing isn't getting high... it's getting out.